

Our place in space

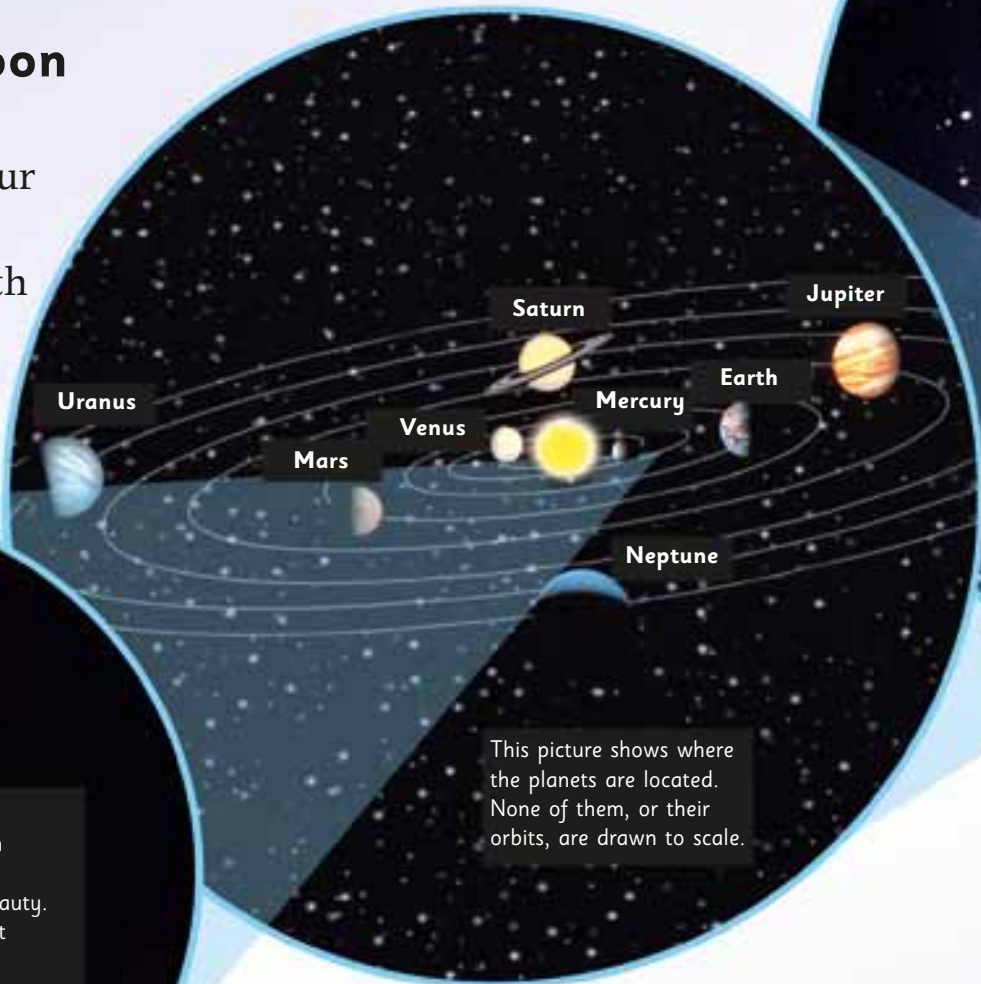
Earth seems huge to us – after all, it can take you a long time just to travel to school! But Earth is only a very tiny part of space. So where exactly does it belong in the Universe?



Earth looks like a swirly blue marble suspended in space.

The Earth and its moon

Earth, our home in space, has one natural satellite, our moon. The moon is about one quarter the size of Earth and, on average, it orbits about 384,000 km (240,000 miles) from us.



This picture shows where the planets are located. None of them, or their orbits, are drawn to scale.

Astronauts who have seen Earth from space are struck by its beauty. One described it as looking like a Christmas-tree decoration.

The solar system

Earth is the third planet from the Sun, at just the right distance from it to support life. The eight planets that orbit the Sun (plus moons, comets, asteroids, meteors, dwarf planets, dust, and gas) make up our solar system.